

DESIGN PHILOSOPHIES

Ever wonder why designs of a particular era start looking similar?
We'll tell you why.

The story of skeuomorphism, in a convoluted way, starts with Xerox. This is because prior to Xerox developing the graphical user interface, computers were command-line driven. To operate a computer, you needed to be a geek. Computers weren't for members of technical proletariat, like most of us. In 1973, before we had graphical user interfaces (GUIs), before Steve Jobs had even thought of the Macintosh, Xerox produced the first personal computer – a humble machine with 128 kilobytes of internal memory. Of course, back then, the term “personal computer” only existed in the pages of geeky magazines and journal.

Why is any of this relevant?

The story of skeuomorphism is almost as old as the story of GUI. We've all heard the anecdote in which Steve Jobs, on a visit to Xerox PARC, had an epiphany about the power of GUI while watching a demonstration of the Xerox alto. He went back to Apple and demanded that his team of engineers